

have a heightened fear of losing this security. This apprehension may lead to their hoarding money out of proportion to what the experts deem as sufficient:

Emergency Savings Account

Minimum = Total monthly expenses multiplied by three

Maximum = Total monthly expenses multiplied by six

Willy's mother Marian followed the expression "Save for a rainy day" religiously. Willy was a senior in high school and was used to his mother's penny-pinching ways. She saved all the time and only spent money when it was absolutely essential. Even then, she never paid full price and always took full advantage of coupons and rebates. Marian was ready for a rainy day; in fact she was ready for years of rainy days.

Her obsession with not spending money came from a Depression-era mentality passed down to her by her parents. They had lost everything they had in the Great Depression and were forced to live very frugally in order to survive. Marian never forgot her parents' stories of their struggle and she decided that she was never going to suffer the way they did. In order to make sure this never happened, she created a security blanket by stockpiling the money she and her husband earned. After twenty-five years of hoarding, Marian had a huge stockpile.

This excessive saving did not come without a price. Willy and his brother Dave grew up feeling deprived, always wanting for more. They were ashamed that they were seemingly the poorest family in their neighborhood. They lacked basic necessities like an adequately heated house, food to fill up their stomachs, and clothes without holes. Their car was getting so old it was on the verge of collapse. They prayed that their parents would make more money so that their situation would improve. Over the years, their parents did get promotions or

